



Disobedient desktops, feverish processors, dirty recycle bins and partitioning blues—we have a remedy for all of them

DNS on Linux

Q. I have problems resolving the names of Web sites on Linux. Thus, I am unable to browse the Net with Netscape unless I provide the actual IP address of the site, which can be found using *nslookup*. The same version of Netscape in my previous installation of Linux worked fine. Why is it giving me trouble now?

Pradeep Shankar
Via e-mail

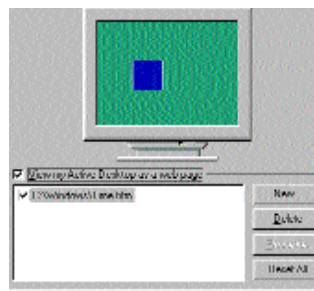
A The problem is not with Netscape. The DNS is not configured or isn't working correctly on your installation of Linux. To cure this you'll have to enter the IP addresses for the domain name servers into the */etc/resolv.conf* file (one address is usually good enough, but it's better to add two). The file must have permissions as *-rw-r--r--* and root ownership. You can get this information from your ISP. For example, if you are connected to a VSNL connection, the file after editing should look like this:
nameserver 202.54.4.24
nameserver 202.54.1.18
You should also check that your */etc/host.conf* file is correctly set up for name

resolution to look up the host's file before the DNS server. It should look like:
order hosts, bind
multi on

Once this is done, you should be able to surf the Internet with domain names.

Rude desktop

Q. My computer was running fine until recently, but now when I start it only a few icons are displayed on the desktop. These icons and Start menu do not respond to the left



Turn off Active Desktop to disable Web content

mouse button. Right-clicking results in the error message: 'Your current settings prohibit

running ActiveX controls on this page. As a result, the page may not display correctly.' I am unable to work on the computer. Please help me.

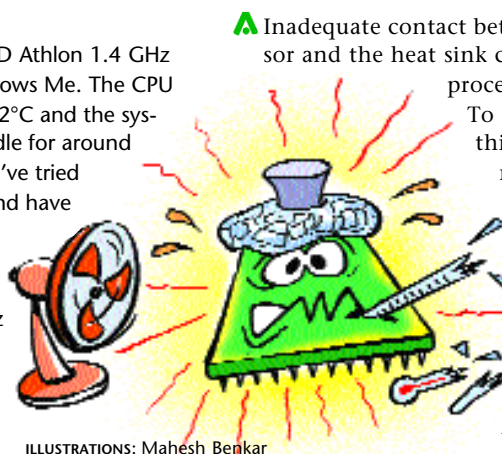
Sanjay Dobhal
Via e-mail

A This might be a prank someone is playing on you. A static page could have been set as the desktop wallpaper, causing it to not respond. Use the key-combination [Win] + [E] to launch Windows Explorer. Open

Overheating Athlon

Q. I have a PC with an AMD Athlon 1.4 GHz processor, running on Windows Me. The CPU temperature often crosses 72°C and the system hangs. But if I leave it idle for around an hour, it works normally. I've tried keeping the cabinet open and have changed the jumper on the motherboard to 100 MHz FSB from 133. Now the processor runs at 1050 MHz and the maximum CPU temperature is around 64°C. However, I want the full speed of the processor. How can I use the processor at 1.4 GHz without overheating it?

Bhalasubramaniyan
Via e-mail



A Inadequate contact between the processor and the heat sink can cause the processor to overheat.

To avoid this, apply a thin layer of thermal paste between the heat sink and processor. You should expect the average temperature of this processor to be around 55°C, which can go to a maximum of 60°C under heavy load. A larger, good quality copper heatsink may also help.